

Drew Pilat

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EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

Master of Science in Computer Science | Expected 2027

- Specialization: High Performance Computing
- Coursework: Parallel Programming, Cloud Computing, Databases, Algorithms, Discrete Mathematics

UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

Bachelor of Business Administration | 2016–2020

Stephen M. Ross School of Business

- Specializations: Financial Markets, Entrepreneurial Law

EXPERIENCE

BENZINGA

Chief of Staff | 2023–2025

- **Predictive Analytics:** Built a churn model in Python for Benzinga Pro, plus the Tableau dashboard customer success used to work the ranked list of at-risk subscribers. 85% accuracy; CLV rose 20%.
- **Product Innovation:** Led development and launch of a mining product that has generated \$500,000+ since inception.
- **Algorithm Development:** Built Benzinga Quant, a multi-factor model behind a daily long/short watchlist and an on-demand scorecard of factor drivers (momentum, mean reversion). Wrote the companion newsletter on which quant strategies were working and which were decaying.
- **Growth Operations:** Launched and scaled the Virtual Events vertical to \$350,000+ in 2024 revenue. Used analytics to set pricing and speed up customer acquisition.
- **Strategic Marketing:** Built attribution models and multivariate testing frameworks for the mobile app's product and marketing strategy. CAC down 33%, conversion up 20%.
- **Strategic Planning:** Evaluated M&A opportunities and partnerships under the COO. Built growth forecasts presented to our largest shareholder, Beringer Capital.

JUMPSTART HEALTH INVESTORS

Investment Associate | 2022–2023

- **Due Diligence:** Evaluated 200+ investment opportunities. Assessed business-model risk and presented investment memos to the Investment Committee.
- **Portfolio Strategy:** Used the fund's historical investment data to shape future deployment and downside-protection frameworks.
- **Market Research:** Researched the healthcare startup ecosystem and spoke directly with founders to find prospects and spot systemic risks.
- **Strategic Advisory:** Advised portfolio company management teams on strategic initiatives and fundraising.

WELLNEST

Co-Founder & Chief Operating Officer | 2019–2022

- **Fundraising:** Raised \$800,000 pre-seed from venture firms and angel investors to build a consumer mental health app.
- **Strategic Partnerships:** Built and managed partnerships with the University of Pennsylvania and Boston University, using their networks to create revenue streams.
- **Product Strategy:** Led product management. Added game design to cut time-to-value for mindfulness routines. Held a 5.0-star App Store rating.
- **Business Operations:** Ran growth and monetization. Covered by Morning Brew and TechCrunch.

PROJECTS

LAVAQUANT

Alpha research platform | quant.drew.fun | 2026

- **Backtest Engine:** Built a date-by-asset backtest engine in pandas and NumPy (rank-IC, IC-IR, Sharpe, turnover, drawdown) across four asset universes.
- **Alpha Language & ML:** Wrote a WorldQuant-style expression language (AST-parsed, function whitelist) and a LightGBM pipeline with embargoed time-series cross-validation.
- **BRAIN Integration:** Connected the WorldQuant BRAIN API (auth, submit, poll, parse) to compare local estimates with official scores. FastAPI on Railway, Next.js on Vercel.

SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python (NumPy, Pandas, Scikit-learn, SciPy, LightGBM, FastAPI), TypeScript, C++, SQL, Unix/Linux, Git
- **Data/Finance:** Financial Modeling, Quantitative Risk Management (VaR, Stress Testing), Tableau, Factor-based Modeling, Derivatives Pricing (Greeks), M&A Due Diligence, Multivariate Testing, Time-Series Analysis